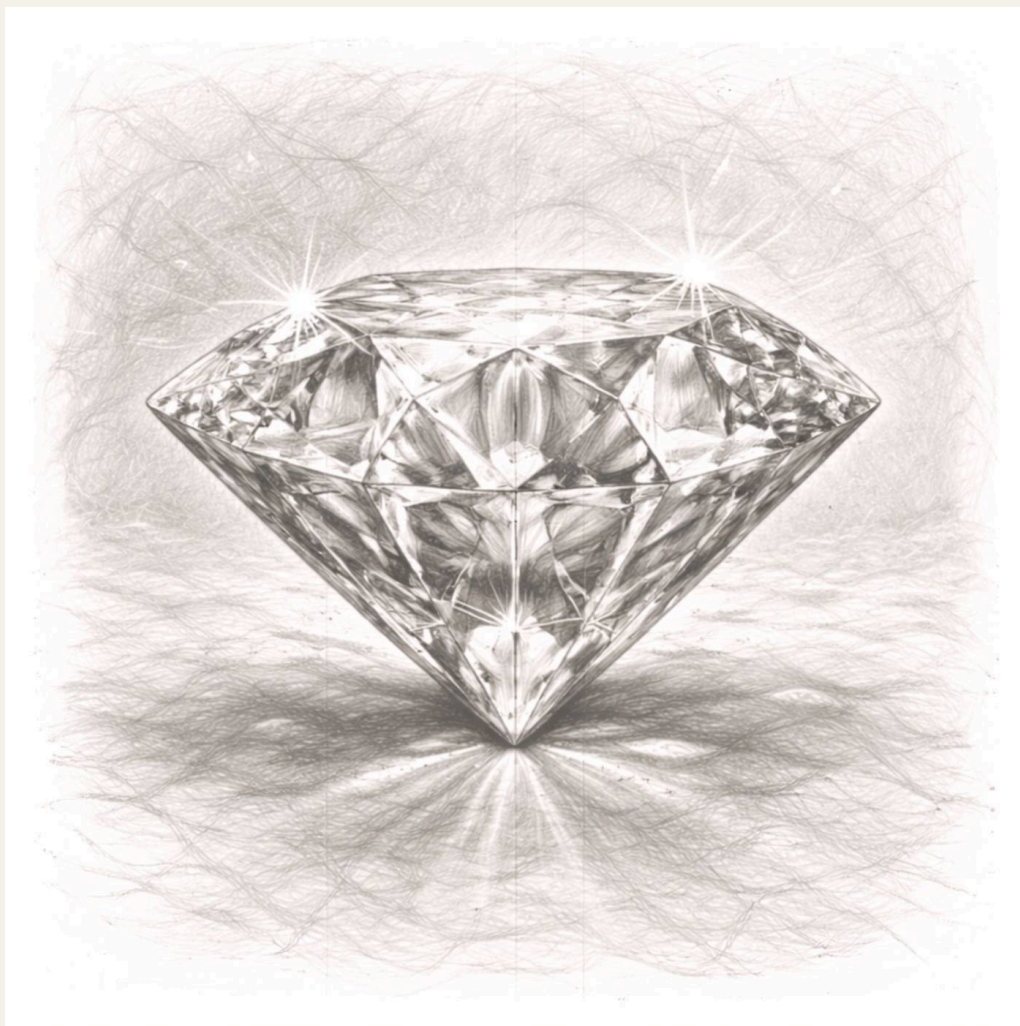


Glorification



A diamond throws light it did not invent. Pressure, cut, and clarity turn a stone into something that shines. Glory, in the drawing, is reflected light.

Before you gather

- Read Day 29, Glorification, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read 1 John 3:2 and Revelation 21:3–5 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What ordinary thing have you seen turn brilliant when the light hit it right?

Leader. Reflected light, not a list of hardships. The book already asked what they want to leave behind, and it used Philippians 3:20. Do not retake that list. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Glorification is not our glow-up. When Christ appears, believers will be made like Him, body and soul. The diamond does not invent the light. It answers it. No one in Christ is finished being discarded.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Glorification is the wonderful moment when Jesus returns and God instantly makes every Christian completely perfect, like Jesus Himself, with no more sin, pain, weakness, or death, so we can live with Him forever in glory.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek doxa — glory, weight, honor, splendor.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 CORINTHIANS 15:42–43

So is it with the resurrection of the dead. What is sown is perishable; what is raised is imperishable. It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power.

Together, open the flashcard for Glorification. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

1 John 3:2 and Revelation 21:3–5

First John 3:2 aims the hope at seeing Jesus and being made like Him. Revelation 21 aims it at God dwelling with His people and making all things new. Together they keep glorification from shrinking into a better body with the same old center.

Beloved, we are God's children now, and what we will be has not yet appeared; but we know that when he appears we shall be like him, because we shall see him as he is. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, "Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man. He will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. He will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death shall be no more, neither shall there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain anymore, for the former things have passed away." And he who was seated on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new."

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What do we already know, and what has not yet appeared? What does John say we will be, and why? **CORE**

Leader. We are God's children now. What we will be has not appeared. We shall be like Him, because we shall see Him as He is. The sight of Christ finishes the likeness, body and soul. That is promise, not a guess.

2. In Revelation 21, what is the center of the new world: the absence of pain, or the presence of God? What happens to death, mourning, and pain, and who does it?

Leader. God with His people is the center. He wipes away every tear. Do not let "no more pain" replace "God himself will be with them," even though we reach for the pain line first.

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Romans 8:30 puts glorified in the past tense, in the same chain as called and justified. Why does Paul speak of a future resurrection as if it were already settled?

CORE

Leader. Because the God who began the chain does not drop the last link. For those He called, glorification is as certain as justification. It is promise, not a wish. He will finish what He started.

4. 1 Corinthians 15:42–43 sets perishable against imperishable, dishonor against glory, weakness against power. Which contrast do you feel most in your body, or in the fight with sin?

Leader. Let them answer in a sentence. Then say: the raising is God's, at Christ's appearing, and it is complete. It is not a long climb into glory. That slow obedience is sanctification. This is the finish. No one in Christ is finished being discarded.

5. 1 John 3:3 says everyone who thus hopes in Him purifies himself as He is pure. How does a future likeness produce present cleanness, instead of the attitude "nothing matters until then"?

Leader. You practice now what you are sure you will be. The hope of glory fuels holiness. It is not a reason to quit. Week 27 and this week belong in one story: already His, and not yet finished, until He appears.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Glorification means that when Christ appears, God will make every believer like Jesus, body and soul, forever.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Visit someone the world treats as finished who does not know Jesus, and help with something physical. Tell them that when Christ appears, He will make His people like Himself, body and soul. No one in Him is discarded.

Leader. The visit is required. A verse in a text is not the challenge. Say Christ. Do not promise glory to someone who has not come to Him. Invite them. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Thank God that what we will be has not yet appeared, and that He has already settled the end in Christ.
2. Ask that the hope of being like Jesus would purify one present habit.
3. Pray for someone weary in a body that is wearing out, that they would hear of Christ and the resurrection.

Before you stumble

Do not describe glory in detail the text does not give. We know more about who we will be with than about the furniture. Do not shame the sick or the old for wanting pain to end. Revelation includes that, under the greater promise: God with us. Glorification is for those in Christ, not an upgrade for decent people. Say that kindly if the room widens it. And say this: no one in Christ is finished being discarded. When He appears, He will raise them, body and soul.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what they think “perfect” will feel like. Then read, “we shall be like him, because we shall see him as he is.” The center is Jesus, not an upgraded self.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Philippians 3:20–21, only as a closing reading if you have two minutes. They reflected on it already. Let it bless the room, not reteach the week: He will transform our lowly body to be like His glorious body.